

South Africa



Area 471,010 sq miles
(1,219,912 sq km)

Population 50.5 million

Capital Pretoria (Tshwane);
Cape Town; Bloemfontein

Currency Rand

Official languages Afrikaans,
English, and 9 African languages

Life expectancy 51 years

For nearly eight decades, South Africa was ruled by a white minority that practiced apartheid, or racial segregation. From 1990, South Africa underwent a political and social revolution, which led to its first multiracial elections in 1994. Antiapartheid crusader Nelson Mandela was South Africa's first elected president.



▲ CITY HALL, CAPE TOWN

This is the limestone façade of the City Hall in Cape Town. It was built in the early 20th century, using materials brought from Europe.

Swaziland



Area 6,704 sq miles
(17,363 sq km)

Population 1.2 million

Capital Mbabane

Currency Lilangeni

Official languages English
and Siswati

Life expectancy 41 years

The landlocked southern African kingdom of Swaziland is governed by a strong hereditary monarchy. Its current ruler, King Mswati III, is one of the world's last absolute monarchs. Swaziland is economically dependent on South Africa for employment, export revenue, and imported goods. Around 97 percent of the population belongs to the Swazi ethnic group.



▼ AFRICAN ELEPHANTS

This small herd of African elephants, including young ones, has assembled at a watering hole in the Etosha National Park, Namibia.

